Ans. The 11th Plan (2007–12) has identified 27 targets at the national-level related to income and poverty, education, health, women and children infrastructure and environment, whereby 13 of the 27 targets, which are easy to monitor, have been set for the states (after due consultations with them). The strategy of setting such development targets is supposed to serve the following purposes to the economy:

(i) It will prevent the Plan faltering from its desired goals and help the Centre to achieve the objectives contained in the National Common Minimum Programme (NCMP);

(ii) It will not only give the Government a real time picture of development, but allow enough time to intervene without waiting for the plan completion;

(iii) The move would also address the issue of regional and sub-regional inequalities;

(iv) It will increase governmental efficiency in going for more 'inclusive growth';

(v) The idea will promote the cause of 'performance budgeting' in a more timely and transparent way;

(vi) It will increase the element of 'governance' among the states as their performance on the 13 easy-to-monitor targets will be key to timely release of Centre's budgetary allocations to them (the Centre and the Planning Commission have been highly critical about the issue of governance at the state level). As the states control the main services (i.e., health, education, drinking water, nutrition, etc.) on which people's standard of living depends directly, it has become essential to make the states more equipped and accountable regarding delivery of these services.

Q. 23 'Leakages are the cause by which food subsidies fail to reach the target population adequately'. Comment.

Ans. As the country headed for the Green Revolution in 1965, a proper method of food distribution also began with the commencement of the Public Distribution System (PDS). The PDS will become the main route to pass food subsidies to the needful population due to the lower level